

# INSTRUCTION SET WITH MASM

## MICROPROCESSORS & INTERFACING (CS F241)

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# Interrupts

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- **Hardware-generated CALL** (externally derived from a hardware signal) OR
- **Software-generated CALL** (internally derived from the execution of an instruction or by some other internal event)
- At times, an internal interrupt is called an **Exception**.
- Either type **interrupts the program** by calling an **interrupt service procedure (ISP) or interrupt handler**

# Interrupt Vectors

- A **4-byte number** stored in the **first 1024 bytes of the memory** (00000H–003FFH) when the microprocessor operates in the real mode.
- In the protected mode, the vector table is replaced by an **interrupt descriptor table** that uses 8-byte descriptors to describe each of the interrupts.
- There are **256 different interrupt vectors**, and each vector contains the address of an interrupt service procedure.
- Each vector contains a value for **IP and CS** that forms the address of the interrupt service procedure. The first 2 bytes contain the IP, and the last 2 bytes contain the CS

# Real Vs Protected Mode

| Real Mode                                    | Protected Mode (PVAM)                            |
|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| Memory addressing up to 1 MB physical memory | Memory addressing up to 16 MB of physical memory |
| No virtual memory support                    | Supports up to 64TB of virtual memory            |
| Memory Protection mechanism is not available | Memory Protection Mechanism is available         |
| Does not support virtual address space       | Gives virtual and physical address space         |
| Does not support LDT and GDT                 | Supports LDT and GDT                             |
| Segment descriptor cache is not available    | Segment descriptor cache is available            |
| Supports Segmentation                        | Supports segmentation and paging.                |

# Interrupt vectors defined by Intel

| <i>Number</i> | <i>Address</i> | <i>Microprocessor</i> | <i>Function</i>                |
|---------------|----------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------|
| 0             | 0H–3H          | All                   | Divide error                   |
| 1             | 4H–7H          | All                   | Single-step                    |
| 2             | 8–BH           | All                   | NMI pin                        |
| 3             | CH–FH          | All                   | Breakpoint                     |
| 4             | 10H–13H        | All                   | Interrupt on overflow          |
| 5             | 14H–17H        | 80186–Core2           | Bound instruction              |
| 6             | 18H–1BH        | 80186–Core2           | Invalid opcode                 |
| 7             | 1CH–1FH        | 80186–Core2           | Coprocessor emulation          |
| 8             | 20H–23H        | 80386–Core2           | Double fault                   |
| 9             | 24H–27H        | 80386                 | Coprocessor segment overrun    |
| A             | 28H–2BH        | 80386–Core2           | Invalid task state segment     |
| B             | 2CH–2FH        | 80386–Core2           | Segment not present            |
| C             | 30H–33H        | 80386–Core2           | Stack fault                    |
| D             | 34H–37H        | 80386–Core2           | General protection fault (GPF) |
| E             | 38H–3BH        | 80386–Core2           | Page fault                     |
| F             | 3CH–3FH        | —                     | Reserved                       |
| 10            | 40H–43H        | 80286–Core2           | Floating-point error           |
| 11            | 44H–47H        | 80486SX               | Alignment check interrupt      |
| 12            | 48H–4BH        | Pentium–Core2         | Machine check exception        |
| 13–1F         | 4CH–7FH        | —                     | Reserved                       |
| 20–FF         | 80H–3FFH       | —                     | User interrupts                |

# Interrupt Instructions

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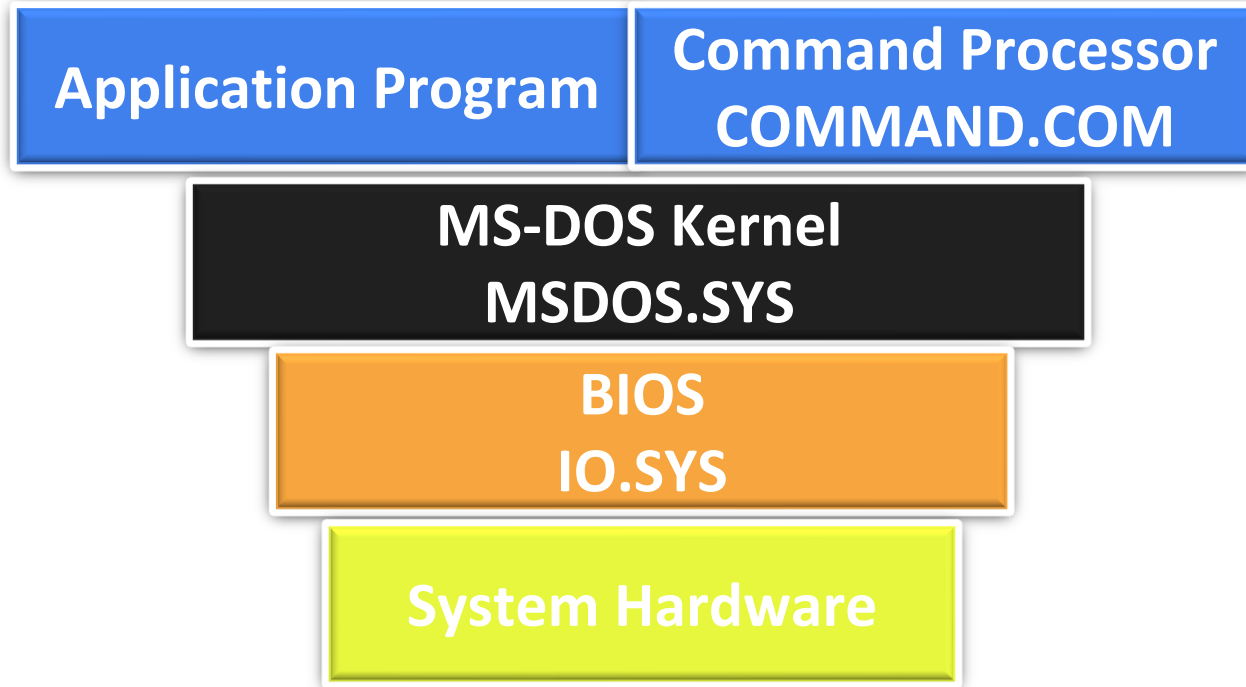
- The microprocessor has three different interrupt instructions that are available to the programmer:  
INT , INTO , INT 3
- Each of these instructions fetches a vector from the vector table, and then calls the procedure stored at the location addressed by the vector.

# BIOS

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- BIOS (Basic Input / Output System) **is firmware embedded on a motherboard** that initializes and controls hardware during the boot process of a computer.
- It provides a standardized way for software to interact with hardware components such as the keyboard, display, disk drives, and other peripherals.
- Hardware-specific, provided by manufacturer
- Resident portion → ROM
- IO.SYS → adding new features to BIOS

# MS-DOS Functions and BIOS Calls





# INT

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- There are **256 different software interrupt** instructions (INTs) available to the programmer.
- Each INT instruction has a numeric operand whose range is 0 to 255 (00H–FFH).
- The address of the interrupt vector is determined by multiplying the interrupt type number by 4.
- INT 10H instruction calls the interrupt service procedure whose address is stored beginning at memory location 40H ( $10H \times 4$ ) in the real mode.
- In the protected mode, the interrupt descriptor is located by multiplying the type number by 8 instead of 4 because each descriptor is 8 bytes long.

# INT



- Only exception to this is INT 3, a 1-byte special software interrupt used for breakpoints.
- The INT instruction performs as a far CALL except that it not only pushes CS and IP onto the stack, but it also pushes the flags onto the stack.
- The INT instruction performs the operation of a PUSHF, followed by a far CALL instruction.

# INT

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Whenever a software interrupt instruction executes, it

- (1) pushes the flags onto the stack
- (2) clears the T and I flag bits
- (3) pushes CS onto the stack
- (4) fetches the new value for CS from the interrupt vector
- (5) pushes IP/EIP onto the stack
- (6) fetches the new value for IP/EIP from the vector
- (7) jumps to the new location addressed by CS and IP/EIP

# IRET/IRETD

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- The interrupt return instruction (IRET) is used only with software or hardware interrupt service procedures.
- Unlike a simple return instruction (RET), the IRET instruction will
  - (1) pop stack data back into the IP
  - (2) pop stack data back into CS
  - (3) pop stack data back into the flag register
- The IRET instruction accomplishes the same tasks as the POPF, followed by a far RET instruction

# INT 3

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- An INT 3 instruction is a special software interrupt designed to function as a breakpoint
- INT 3 is a 1-byte instruction, while the others are 2-byte instructions
- It is common to insert an INT 3 instruction in software to interrupt or break the flow of the software, called a breakpoint
- Why we need breakpoints?

# INT 3

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How INT3 works?

1. Flag register value is pushed on to the stack.
2. CS value of the return address and IP value of the return address are pushed on to the stack.
3. IP is loaded from the contents of the word location  $3 \times 4 = 0000CH$
4. CS is loaded from the contents of the next word location.
5. Interrupt Flag and Trap Flag are reset to 0

# INTO

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- Interrupt on overflow (INTO) is a conditional software interrupt that tests the overflow flag (O).
- If  $O = 0$ , the INTO instruction performs no operation; if  $O = 1$  and an INTO instruction executes, an interrupt occurs via vector type number 4.
- Either the JO instruction or INTO instruction detects the overflow condition

# INTO

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It is active only when the overflow flag is set to 1 and branches to the interrupt handler whose interrupt type number is 4 using following steps.

- Flag register values are pushed on to the stack.
- CS value of the return address and IP value of the return address are pushed on to the stack.
- IP is loaded from the contents of word location  $4 \times 4 = 00010H$
- CS is loaded from the contents of the next word location.
- Interrupt flag and Trap flag are reset to 0



# INT 21H

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- It invokes a software interrupt to call the DOS function pointed to by the value in the AH (accumulator high) register.
- **Set up AH register:** Before calling INT 21H, you load the AH register with the number corresponding to the specific DOS function you want to call.
- Reading or writing data to a file, the DX register is commonly used to specify the memory buffer or file handle.

E.g.

MOV DL, 'A' ; Set DL register with ASCII value of 'A'

MOV AH, 02H ; Set AH register with function code 02H for write character

INT 21H ; Call DOS interrupt 21H

# Common AH values

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- AH = 01H:** Read character from standard input (keyboard).
- AH = 02H:** Write character to standard output (console).
- AH = 06H:** Direct console output (write string to standard output).
- AH = 07H:** Direct console input (read string from standard input).
- AH = 09H:** Write string to standard output with '\$' terminator.
- AH = 0AH:** Read string from standard input with buffer length.
- AH = 0CH:** Check keyboard status without waiting.
- AH = 0EH:** Write character to standard output, with advanced control.
- AH = 19H:** Get current default drive.
- AH = 25H:** Set interrupt vector.
- AH = 26H:** Create new PSP (Program Segment Prefix).
- AH = 3DH:** Open existing file or create new file.
- AH = 3EH:** Close file.
- AH = 3FH:** Read from file or device.
- AH = 40H:** Write to file or device.
- AH = 42H:** Move file pointer.
- AH = 4BH:** Execute program.
- AH = 4CH:** Terminate program with return code.

# Example: Print a numerical value (integer) on the screen

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```
.MODEL SMALL
.STACK 100H

.DATA
    num DW 1234          ; The numerical value to be printed

.CODE
MAIN PROC
    MOV AX, @DATA        ; Initialize DS register
    MOV DS, AX

    MOV AX, num           ; Move the numerical value into AX register
    CALL PRINT_NUM        ; Call the procedure to print the number

    MOV AH, 4CH           ; DOS function to terminate the program
    INT 21H

MAIN ENDP
```

# Example: Print a numerical value (integer) on the screen

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; Procedure to print a numerical value

PRINT\_NUM PROC

; Convert the number to a string representation

MOV CX, 10 ; Initialize divisor for division by 10

MOV BX, 10 ; Initialize digit place counter

MOV SI, OFFSET buffer ; Set SI to point to buffer for storing the string

ADD SI, 6 ; Move SI to the end of the buffer

MOV WORD PTR [SI], '\$' ; Null-terminate the string

MOV DX, 0 ; Clear DX register

# Example: Print a numerical value (integer) on the screen

```
; Loop to extract digits from the number
EXTRACT_LOOP:
    XOR DX, DX    ; Clear DX register
    DIV CX        ; Divide AX by 10, quotient in AX, remainder in DX
    ADD DL, '0'   ; Convert the remainder to ASCII character
    DEC SI        ; Move SI to the next position in the buffer
    MOV [SI], DL  ; Store the ASCII character in the buffer
    INC BX        ; Increment digit place counter
    TEST AX, AX   ; Check if quotient is zero
    JNZ EXTRACT_LOOP ; If not, continue the loop

; Display the string on the screen
MOV AH, 09H    ; DOS function to display string
MOV DX, SI     ; Load DX with the address of the string
INT 21H
RET
PRINT_NUM ENDP
END MAIN
```

# An Interrupt Service Procedure

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```
0000                                INTS    PROC    FAR USES  AX
0000 03  C3                        ADD     AX, BX
0002 03  05                        ADD     AX, BP
0004 03  C7                        ADD     AX, DI
0006 03  C6                        ADD     AX, SI
0008 CF                            IRET
0009                                INTS    ENDP
```

# Opening the File

Open a New File/Rewrite a File: INT 21h, function 3Ch

Input: AH = 3Ch

DS:DX = address of file name, which is an ASCII string  
(a string ending with a 0 byte)

CL = attribute

Output: if successful, AX = file handle

Error if CF = 1, error code in AX (3, 4, or 5)

Example: write a program to open a new read-only file called FILE1.

```
.model small
.stack 100h
.data
FNAME          DB      'FILE1', 0
HANDLE DB      ?
.code
.startup
    MOV AH, 3Ch      ; open file function
    LEA DX, FNAME    ; DX has filename address
    MOV CL, 1        ; read-only attribute
    INT 21h          ; open file
    MOV HANDLE, AX    ; save handle or error code
    JC OPEN_ERROR     ; jump if error
```

# Opening the existing file

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## Open an Existing File: INT 21h, function 3Dh

Input: AH = 3Dh

DS:DX = address of file name, which is an ASCII string  
(a string ending with a 0 byte)

AL = access code:           0 means open for reading  
                              1 means open for writing  
                              2 means open for both

Output: if successful, AX = file handle

Error if CF = 1, error code in AX (2, 4, 5 or 12)



# Read from the existing file

**Read from a File: INT 21h, function 3Fh**

Input: AH = 3Fh  
BX = file handle  
CX = number of bytes to read  
DS:DX = memory buffer address

Output: AX = number of bytes actually read  
if AX=0 or AX < CX, end of file encountered  
Error if CF = 1, error code in AX (5, 6)

Example: Write some code to read a 512-byte from a file. Assume file handle is stored in variable HANDLE, and BUFFER is a 512 byte buffer.

```
.data
    HANDLE DW      ?
    BUFFER DB 512 DUP(0)
    ...

.code
    ...
    MOV AX, 3Fh      ; read file function
    MOV BX, HANDLE   ; get handle
    MOV CX, 512      ; read 512 bytes
    INT 21H          ; read file, AX = bytes read
    JC READ_ERROR    ; jump if error
    ...
```

# Writing to a File

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**Write to a File: INT 21h, function 40h**

Input: AH = 40h

BX = file handle

CX = number of bytes to write

DS:DX = data address

Output: AX = number of bytes written

if AX=0 or AX < CX, error (full disk)

Error if CF = 1, error code in AX (5, 6)



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# THANK YOU

